

FROM ANGUL TO A LIFE OF SERVICE

A Personal Journey from Animal Lover to Dedicated Sevak

THE BEGINNING — ANGUL, ODISHA

I and my whole family stayed in Angul, Odisha, from 1982 to 2015. My schooling and college life were deeply connected with this place. Angul was not merely where I lived—it gradually became a part of my identity, carrying memories of my school, teachers, friends and the places I still remember with affection.

A TURNING POINT — BECOMING A CAREGIVER

While pursuing Intermediate Science, I completely turned myself towards a vegan and animal-caregiver way of life. At that time, six pets lived inside our quarter boundary in NALCO NAGAR, Angul. My father was a retired NALCO employee, and our home became an early space where my bond with animals grew stronger.

THE YEARS IN DHENKANAL — ENGINEERING AND THE WILD

Before B.Tech, I spent a year preparing for Odisha JEE at Cuttack. Later, while pursuing my B.Tech at Synergy Institute of Engineering and Technology in Dhenkanal, I continued helping animals whenever I could. The college had been built near an NH bypass road, surrounded by an environment that still felt like a jungle.

In whatever little time I had outside studies—because, honestly, in student life there seems to be no real word called 'leisure' or 'rest'—I would take my bicycle and observe the jungle side. From a safe distance, I often saw packs of large wolves at dawn and around midnight, and sometimes elephants. Most often, I saw monkeys. I loved observing wild animals without disturbing them.

Since childhood, I have carried one wish: how can I understand animals without making wrong assumptions about what they feel or want? I wished I could converse with them. Perhaps there is no science for such a conversation, but many times I felt that they wanted to share something or make themselves understood. And I felt foolish because I could never truly read them without my own assumptions.

2005 — RETURNING TO NALCO NAGAR

After completing engineering, I returned to NALCO NAGAR in 2005. I began seeing many road-accident cases involving cows, bulls and oxen. My heart filled with regret and mercy for them. For the first time in my life, I stood beside them not simply as an observer, but as a Sevak.

I felt as if NALCO NAGAR were my native place. The Jagannath Temple was my favourite place. My school playground, school teachers and friends remained close to my heart. And now, injured animals were becoming another part of that emotional connection.

MILLU — MY FIRST COWORKER IN THIS SERVICE

MILLU was my first coworker. He was younger than me, but he stood beside me with courage. Later, some students joined as volunteers. Millu, my brothers, my close friends and I together began caring for injured cows.

A TEMPORARY SHELTER — SERVICE WITH WHATEVER WE HAD

We made a temporary roadside shelter using trees, bamboo and tarpaulin. We arranged food and water, medicines and veterinary consultations. When surgery or external fixation was required, we called veterinarians to the spot. Whatever they charged, we simply agreed because the priority was the animal's treatment.

If hospital treatment was necessary, we arranged a vehicle and took the animal to hospital. In other cases, veterinarians measured injured legs and advised us about supportive structures that could be fabricated quickly. We followed their instructions, helped change the animal's position regularly, protected her from mosquitoes and observed her food habits, dung and urine conditions. We did whatever the doctors advised, with all our heart.



At that time I had not joined any organization, so Millu and I dedicated ourselves to this service. One of us was always with her, working in alternate shifts. It was exhausting, but it felt meaningful.

THE GOSHALA DECISION — A PAINFUL LESSON

Some respectable people told us that continuing this way would make us ill and suggested that the cow should be shifted to a goshala or NGO. I heard, perhaps for the first time, about an organization offering such service. Somehow, neither Millu nor I felt that it was the right decision. But others agreed, and my family also urged me to follow the suggestion.

An uncle contacted a goshala associated with an NGO in Bhubaneswar and asked about the cow. They assured him that they would take care of her. The next day, Millu, my brother and his friend took the cow there. After reaching the place and seeing its condition, everyone in our group felt that it had been a disastrous decision. But our uncle insisted that we leave her there and trust them.

We told them that after her complete recovery, we would return with the media and take her back safely. But hardly a week later, when we called asking for video updates, we were simply told that the cow had died of malaria, along with what felt like excuses. That day left a deep mark on me.

THE REALIZATION — RESPONSIBILITY CANNOT BE DELEGATED EASILY

That experience taught me something I have never forgotten: if God has handed a responsibility to us, perhaps we should obey that responsibility rather than searching for an easier alternative. Service is not always convenient. Sometimes it demands time, money, sleeplessness, physical effort and emotional strength. But when a life is placed in our care, responsibility must come before comfort.

MY SIMPLE APPEAL — THREE THINGS ARE ENOUGH TO BEGIN

I am truly speaking from my heart: I can provide better and more consistent service if I receive support in only three areas:

1. LAND WITH SHELTER	A safe, secure place where rescued animals can stay and recover.
2. FINANCIAL SUPPORT	Food, medicines, treatment, transport and other essential rescue expenses.
3. DOCTORS' SUPPORT	Veterinary guidance, emergency treatment, surgery and professional medical care.

THE JOURNEY CONTINUES

Over the years, many dogs and calves were rescued, treated and eventually returned to the street after recovery. Each rescue created a new energy within me. I learned to help without calculating only the present or worrying constantly about the future. Every recovered animal became a reminder that even a small act of care can change a life.

“A SOCIETY BECOMES KINDER WHEN IT DOES NOT TURN AWAY FROM A LIFE THAT CANNOT SPEAK FOR ITSELF.”

